

LIFE AFTER

A Maritime Musical

Lyrics by Stephanie L Carlin

Music by Marie Incontrera

Book by David Quang Pham

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Plot Summary

Life After is a retrofuturistic musical about a marine biologist and an angel investor bunkered down in an abyss, having believed in the great flood of 2012.

In an underwater habitat in an abyss, [marine biologist] keeps their sanity by observing the deep-sea community, especially befriending the baby giant squids. [angel investor] feels caught in the toils of their own financial sacrifices, having spent all their wealth on reinforcing their habitat for centuries to come by 2012. They assume their loss of communication with the land is evident of humanity's mass extinction.

Their world turns upside down when an explorer in a submarine runs into the habitat. [explorer] reveals to them that the world never ended. [angel investor] pleads to [explorer] to call for help as their escape pod got lost due to the baby giant squids assuming it is another giant squid. [angel investor] also cannot take [marine biologist]'s insane conversations with the baby giant squids anymore. [explorer] sets a deal where in exchange for the giant squid's location, [explorer] would save them. [explorer] got into giant squids when they saw the first footage of one broadcasted in January 2013.

[marine biologist] does not take the deal, believing [explorer] to be a poaching zookeeper. [angel investor] tries to lure [marine biologist] with possible future investors *and romance*. [marine biologist] obliges and asks the baby giant squids to call out to their parent giant squid.

The giant squid attacks [explorer]'s submarine before the giant squid could be netted. It turns out that [marine biologist] asked the baby giant squids to warn their parent. [explorer]'s demise destroys the pair's chance to resurface.

[marine biologist] notes that money is pointless in the afterlife and so is life after. After long living under depths and death, [angel investor] goes "sleeper agent" and starts seeking the sleeper sharks, the predator of giant squids.

Fin.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

[**MB** - Thuy Duc], adult, a marine biologist

[**AI** - Adrian/Adrienne Harbor], adult, an angel investor

[**E** - Moses Whalen], adult, an explorer and submarine puppeteer

[**Puppeteer**], anyone, the one handling the sea creature puppets

● People of the Global Majority most represent the experiences of these underwater humans; cast accordingly

MUSICAL NUMBERS

1. "Life Before" MB, AI, E
2. " " MB, AI, E
3. " " MB, AI, E
4. " " MB, AI, E
5. "Life After (The End is Coming)" MB, AI, E

SCENE 1

ABYSSAL HABITAT

1. "LIFE BEFORE (PLACEHOLDER OPENING NUMBER)"

A transparent wall showing the deep-sea community is situated in the back of the habitat. There is a miniature scale of the habitat stationed nearby.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] looks about the home while [MARINE BIOLOGIST] stares at the puppet BABY GIANT SQUIDS swimming outside.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]
LIFE BEFORE WAS GREAT.
LIFE BEFORE WAS WELL MADE.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]
Life before, we were made of gills and scales.
I'd kill to have a tail!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]
Dead humans tell no tales.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]
Indeed. There are no tales left on land.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]
2012 has taken so much away from us!

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]
(Intimately)
But not us...

[ANGEL INVESTOR]
This habitat... Home. What I've funded. You trust-

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]
It's the most fun I've had!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]
You mean the most insanity you've had.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]
(to BABY GIANT SQUIDS)
Am I insane? Ink if "yes." Don't if "no."

The BABY GIANT SQUIDS do not ink.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST] (CONT'D)

See?!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Yes... The sea is everything to you...

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

The sea is everything to the world. To life.
The beginnning, middle, and end.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

2012 is the end of our lives. 2013 is the end
of our world.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

(to BABY GIANT SQUIDS)

How would y'all celebrate the end?

The BABY GIANT SQUIDS ink.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST] (CONT'D)

Aww... Little giant fellas are too young to
understand the concept of... *death*.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Life cannot get any stupider.

A toy submarine enters and bumps
into the miniature scale habitat,
scaring away the BABY GIANT
SQUIDS.

[EXPLORER]

Is this the afterlife?!

End of "LIFE BEFORE"

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

I'll take you there! What the Hell, bud?!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Hold up.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

You're always held up.

[EXPLORER]

You hold up. What are you two doing down in the
abyss?

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Surviving. You?

[EXPLORER]

Thriving.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Where did you come from?

[EXPLORER]

[Ridiculously Dry City, State, Country].

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

The great flood even got [Ridiculously Dry City, State, Country].

[EXPLORER]

The great flood?

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Quit flooding us with questions.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Give us some answers.

[EXPLORER]

Why don't you check it out for yourself? Come up to the shores.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

No way.

[EXPLORER]

No way?

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

No way out. We're stuck here.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Nowhere. There's nowhere to go anyways.

[EXPLORER]

There's Time Square.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Isn't that underwater by now?

[EXPLORER]

Yes, schools of fishes called "tourists." No, we're not underwater.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Time Square should be.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Is everyone still alive?!

[EXPLORER]

Alive as you.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

So dead inside.

[EXPLORER]

Well, get this through your empty heads: the world did not end!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

What?

[EXPLORER]

December 21 is a myth. There is no great flood.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

But the world went crazy!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

You're the one who've gone crazy!

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Who invested in my crazy?

Beat.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST] (CONT'D)

Crazys help crazys.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

(to [EXPLORER])

You're the first person we've had contact with.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

We've made many friends.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Giant squids are not your friends.

[EXPLORER]

Giant squids...?

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

I'm the giant squid and [Angel Investor] is the baby squid.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

[Marine Biologist] is the baby squid.

[EXPLORER]

Oh so it's an allegory for your relationship.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Gory with blood boiling.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

The giant squid keeps giving us fish carcass like a kitten.

[EXPLORER]

Like a cat in the tree, are you stuck in this deep ravine?

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Yes.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

No!

[EXPLORER]

[Angel Investor]... [Angel Investor][Angel Investor Surname]?

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

They live up to the aquatic name.

[EXPLORER]

You fund the contractors that build submarine parts that I assemble and use. Cheap.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

But not efficient.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

I funded this underwater habitat since 2009, with some sketchy former naval personnel who constructed the past SEALABs. I ran out of money by the time we got around to the escape pod.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

The baby giant squids toyed around with it. They thought it was another giant squid with its single window.

[EXPLORER]

That escape pod you're talking about may be the one found in the Pacific giant trash patch.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Great Pacific Garbage Patch?

[EXPLORER]

The world may not be over, but it is still trash.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Will you look at that. There is nothing of value to return to.

[EXPLORER]

Wait. I can take you up. You have got to try the goldfish mac and cheese.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Goldfishes are abominations... but with mac and cheese!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

I'm done with canned mac and cheese. I miss being in the wheatfields with cows.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

We will not kowtow to you.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

I will the second we reach land.

[EXPLORER]

That's the spirit! All you need to do is take me to your giant squid.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

You ghoul!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

(to [MARINE BIOLOGIST])

We're fools!

[EXPLORER]

You were misled to the depths of Hell. I'm here to lead you back to the heavens.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Angel investor or not, there's no money in the new life you'd have.

[EXPLORER]

There is indeed money in new life: that giant squid.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Don't lay a single turbine on my squid!

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

The real monster here is [Marine Biologist]. You do not want to mess with them.

[EXPLORER]

I'm here to capture... memories.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

My Japanese colleagues captured the first footages of a giant squid in mid 2012. They have yet to release it into the public.

[EXPLORER]

The news just did. That's why I'm here.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

(to [MARINE BIOLOGIST])

You'll cut their time short if we agree for them to cut our time here.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

I love our time here.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

(Intimately and pathetically)

You'd love our time in the air.

[EXPLORER]

I guess you two are busy. I'll swing by-

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Stay!

The BABY GIANT SQUIDS return.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Oh sure, you'll listen when they say "stay."

[EXPLORER]

You must be playing games. You can talk to squids?

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

These babies can answer that. Ink if "yes."
Don't if "no."

The BABY GIANT SQUIDS reluctantly
ink.

[EXPLORER]

I'd love to connect you with my friends at the
aquarium.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

The aquarium...

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Yes, where we've had our dates- *meetings*.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

I see...

[EXPLORER]

It's better than the sea. You know that. With
good lighting and well-fed animals.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Well water me stupid.

(to the BABY GIANT SQUIDS)

Can you get your mother here? This nice human
would like a word with her. Take good care of
[Explorer].

The BABY GIANT SQUIDS swim off.

SCENE 2

The GIANT SQUID emerges.

The submarine shoots a net towards
the GIANT SQUID.

The GIANT SQUID deflects the net.
The giant squid pulls the
[Explorer] and their submarine
into the twilight zone.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST] (CONT'D)

The net has no worth.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Neither is my net worth! What have you done?!

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

The real question is "what is done?" The world
is.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Life before, we were made of lungs and skin.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Now we're back where we belong.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Life before will return again.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Go marvel at *this* world.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] faceplants on the
glass.

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

Here's to... depths and death-

[MARINE BIOLOGIST]

Here's to life after.

[MARINE BIOLOGIST] walks off.

SCENE 3

[ANGEL INVESTOR]

This is all just a dream...

A SLEEPER SHARK emerges and rams
into the glass that [ANGEL
INVESTOR] is touching.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] is taken aback.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] (CONT'D)

I know your kind. You're the mascot for a loan investment company I worked for.

The SLEEPER SHARK paces.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] (CONT'D)

A sleeper shark. I loved that commercial where you eat your competition, the squid mascot-

The SLEEPER SHARK pays attention.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] (CONT'D)

Are you looking for the giant?

[ANGEL INVESTOR] points out.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] (CONT'D)

Time to get my hands dirty. Get their tentacles dirty!

The SLEEPER SHARK swims off.

[ANGEL INVESTOR] (CONT'D)

There shall be no life after.

FIN